

C-Direct — Site Audit & Growth Strategy

PRÉPARÉ LE 29 JUILLET 2026 · POUR DÉCISION, RIEN N'EST CONSTRUIT SANS VOTRE OK

RÉSUMÉ

You asked me to check how useful, workable, and good the site actually is, and to look at the market to improve C-Direct's chances of success and long-term share. Short version: a lot of real, working product has been built — matching, notifications, accounting export, Instant Booking, content, calendar tools. But there is one gap that matters more than any UI polish: **the payment guarantee your own payments architecture already designed (Stripe Connect, T-24h card hold, dual Interac/card settlement) is not built yet**, while the homepage already advertises it ("Paiement Interac direct") as if it were live. With a September 2026 launch target, that is the single highest-leverage thing to fix — both because it is the #1 trust lever for pharmacists deciding to trust this platform with their pay, and because C-Direct currently charges no fee at all, so there is no revenue mechanism live either.

Everything below is organized the same way: what's already working, what's missing or mismatched, and what the Quebec market looks like — with concrete, sourced numbers, not guesses. Every recommendation is tagged **REQUIRES YOUR OK**. I have not built or changed anything based on this review — this is a proposal document only.

WHAT'S ALREADY WORKING WELL

- Two-sided matching with real automation: distance/postal-code-based compatibility count, automatic indemnity calculation (per diem, mileage, lodging beyond a distance threshold), a cancellation-penalty system with automatic invoicing.
- Notifications: SMS + email on publish, confirmation messages, quiet-hours preference per user — a real, working diffusion pipeline (with a known Twilio carrier-filtering issue already diagnosed, see the July 29 action list).
- Trust/safety tooling for admins: account verification queue, mutual pharmacist–pharmacy exclusions/blocking, ratings and reviews.
- Money bookkeeping for locums: automatic invoice generation on contract completion, a T2125-ready CSV export, and (as of today) a calendar + period-filtered dashboard and a place to log income earned outside C-Direct so the yearly picture is complete.
- Retention/differentiation features most competitors don't have yet: Instant Booking with favorite pharmacists, a proficiency-by-software display, and a Dispensaire content hub (career/finance/patient articles) as a reason to open the app between shifts.
- Bilingual (FR/EN), mobile-responsive layout, and a real admin console for oversight.

THE CRITICAL GAP: PAYMENT GUARANTEE ISN'T BUILT YET

Your payments architecture document is precise and already legally reasoned: Stripe Connect, a card authorization placed T-24h before every shift as the guarantee, cancel-if-confirmed / capture-if-not, and a flat ~\$39 fee. It's a genuinely good design — it keeps C-Direct out of the gross wage flow (the core legal constraint) while still guaranteeing the locum gets paid. **None of it exists in the live codebase yet** — there is no Stripe integration anywhere in the code, and no platform fee is charged on any contract today.

What actually happens today, live:

- A pharmacist marks a contract "Marquer complété," which auto-generates an invoice (this part works well).
- Payment itself happens entirely off-platform — the pharmacy sends money however they arrange it — with the pharmacist clicking a manual "Païement reçu" button once they've received it. There is no verification, no deadline enforcement, no guarantee, and no consequence if a pharmacy simply never pays.
- The FAQ says exactly this: «Directement par la pharmacie, par virement Interac, selon les modalités du réseau» — no mention of a guarantee because there isn't one yet.

Where this becomes a real risk:

- **The homepage already markets it as live.** The hero section leads with "Païement Interac direct" as a headline trust badge, and the features list says "Païement Interac déposé directement dans votre compte." A pharmacist who reads that and later discovers payment is just an honor-system invoice will reasonably feel misled — exactly at the trust-building moment that decides whether they use C-Direct again.
- **There is currently no revenue mechanism.** No fee is charged anywhere in the code. Today, C-Direct is a full-featured, unmonetized product.
- **It isn't on the pre-launch checklist.** PRELANCEMENT.md tracks Google sign-in, test data cleanup, the Loi 25/CASL legal review, and more — but has no line for building the payment guarantee at all, which suggests it may have dropped off the radar while feature work continued.
- **The runway is short.** Your architecture doc names a September 2026 launch target — roughly five to six weeks from today.

1

Prioritize building the Stripe Connect payment guarantee

REQUIRES YOUR OK

Exactly as already specced in your payments architecture — card authorization at T-24h, cancel/capture logic, dual Interac/card settlement, the \$39 fee. This is the highest-leverage item in this whole report: it is simultaneously your trust story, your only revenue mechanism, and a promise already made publicly on the homepage.

This is a substantial build touching money movement and compliance (fraud controls, state machine, webhooks, Connect onboarding) — not a quick edit. I'd suggest treating it as its own project with a dedicated session, not folding it into other feature work.

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2

Until it's built, make the marketing match reality

Either fast-track the build above, or temporarily soften “Paiement Interac direct” on the homepage/FAQ to avoid a mismatch between promise and product during onboarding of your first real users.

REQUIRES YOUR OK

OTHER PROMISES WORTH RECONCILING BEFORE LAUNCH

None of these are as urgent as the payment gap, but each is a place where what's marketed and what's live don't quite line up yet, or where a known pre-launch item is still open.

3

Google Agenda sync is fully coded but not switched on

REQUIRES YOUR OK

The homepage promises “Vos disponibilités suivent votre calendrier Google — en temps réel,” and the two-way sync code is genuinely built and looks solid. It's just gated on a Google OAuth Client ID that hasn't been created yet (PRELANCEMENT.md has the exact 4-step recipe already written out). Clicking “Connecter” today tells the user it isn't configured — a small, well-scoped task, not a rebuild.

4

Google sign-in still disabled

REQUIRES YOUR OK

Carried over from earlier: Supabase Authentication → Providers → Google needs to be enabled with a Client ID/Secret and redirect URLs. Code and button are already correct.

5

Confirm the Loi 25 / CASL legal review is actually signed

REQUIRES YOUR OK

PRELANCEMENT.md lists this as an open item (“Revue légale Loi 25 / CASL signée (Martin) avant d'inviter des usagers”). Given C-Direct will be handling licence numbers, addresses, and eventually payment data, I'd treat this as a hard gate before any public user-acquisition push — not something to launch around.

6

Decide on the ~24 remaining test contracts and Cloudflare Access wall

REQUIRES YOUR OK

Both already tracked in your own checklist (PRELANCEMENT.md) as pending your decision/timing — flagging them here only so they don't get lost among today's larger findings.

UX / TRUST OPPORTUNITIES

7

Surface trust signals on public pages

REQUIRES YOUR OK

Right now, verification status, OPQ licence numbers, and ratings only appear after login. Since the market shortage means pharmacists have options, a public (or FAQ-embedded) mention of “every pharmacist is licence-verified” and aggregate rating stats could reduce first-visit hesitation for both sides — especially against a bigger, more anonymous competitor like BeLocum.

8

Open the Dispensaire feed to the public (not just logged-in users)

REQUIRES YOUR OK

Built today as an internal feature. A public, unauthenticated version of published articles turns the same content into an SEO/organic-acquisition channel — Quebec-pharmacist career and finance topics are exactly the kind of long-tail search terms that bring in signups for free. Same content, wider reach, no extra writing.

9

Watch the “**approbation sous 24h**” promise at scale

The signup flow promises 24-hour approval. Worth confirming the admin verification queue has an owner/monitoring plan so that promise holds once real signups start arriving, not just during testing.

REQUIRES YOUR OK

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THE QUEBEC MARKET, IN NUMBERS

The underlying market dynamic favors a platform like C-Direct — the numbers describe a real, structural shortage, not a soft or cyclical one.

Metric	Figure	Source
Community pharmacists in Quebec	~7,166 (5,158 salaried + 2,008 owners, 2022)	Ordre des pharmaciens du Québec (OPQ)
Total OPQ membership	just past 10,000	OPQ
Community-pharmacy positions unfilled	~12% (about 1,149 pharmacists)	AQPP mémoire
Locum / remplacement hours worked in 2024	over 1 million hours	AQPP mémoire
Trend AQPP is flagging	placement agencies pulling pharmacists out of permanent roles, worsening the shortage	AQPP mémoire / press coverage

A regulatory tailwind — scoped precisely

Quebec's *Loi limitant le recours aux services d'une agence de placement de personnel... dans le secteur de la santé et des services sociaux* (in force since October 2023) is phasing out placement-agency use across the **public** health and social-services network — including hospital pharmacy departments — by 2025–2026. This is a real tailwind for non-agency models generally, but it is scoped to the public network. **C-Direct's actual market is private/community pharmacies**, which this law does not directly touch. It's a useful data point about where the province is steering policy (away from agencies, toward direct relationships) but not a regulatory mandate that drives community pharmacies to C-Direct — worth using carefully in messaging so as not to overstate it.

Direct competitors

	PharmaGap	BeLocum	Recrupharm
Model	Direct marketplace, Quebec-only, launched 2025	Multi-province, pharmacy + dental, on-demand	Traditional placement agency
Locum pays	Free, keeps 100%	Effectively ~\$200/shift less than C-Direct on a comparable shift (per rate-spread analysis)	Agency margin built into placement
Pharmacy pays	Subscription: pay-per-contract or flat monthly ("Unlimited")	~\$1,560 for a shift costing C-Direct's pharmacy ~\$1,399–1,441	Agency fee/markup
Payment guarantee	Unclear from public materials	Not escrow-based per available information	N/A — agency employs/pays directly

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C-Direct's edge	Closest direct twin — differentiate on payment guarantee once built, plus content/tools	Cheaper for pharmacy AND better payout for locum on both rails, per the designed pricing	Not an agency — direct relationship, no CNESST/placement-agency overhead passed to either side
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BeLocum figures reflect the \$20/h spread example already worked out in C-Direct's own payments architecture doc, not a published BeLocum price list — treat as an illustrative comparison, not a quoted rate.

BUILDING SUSTAINABLE MARKET SHARE

These are aimed specifically at durability — share that holds up over years, not a launch-week spike. Every item below is a proposal only.

10

Ship the payment guarantee before any paid acquisition push

REQUIRES YOUR OK

This is both point 1 from earlier and the foundation for everything below: it's hard to build durable trust-based share on a promise the product doesn't keep yet. Sequence acquisition spend after this, not alongside it.

11

Win density in the highest-shortage regions first, not province-wide

REQUIRES YOUR OK

With ~1,149 unfilled positions concentrated unevenly, a locum on C-Direct is far more valuable if every other pharmacy nearby is also on it — that's what makes Instant Booking actually instant. Consider picking 2–3 regions with the worst vacancy rates and getting genuinely dense there (most pharmacies + most locums in that area) before spreading thin province-wide.

12

Turn the fee structure into the headline pitch, not fine print

REQUIRES YOUR OK

The three-column price comparison already sketched in your own architecture (Interac vs. card vs. BeLocum) is a genuinely strong, concrete pitch: cheaper for the pharmacy, ~\$200 better for the locum, on the same shift. Once the payment system is live, that table belongs on the booking screen and in sales conversations with pharmacy owners — it's a rare case where the honest number is also the best marketing.

13

Lean into “direct relationship, not an agency” — with Martin's sign-off on wording

REQUIRES YOUR OK

Given the regulatory direction of travel in Quebec and AQPP's own concern about agencies pulling pharmacists from permanent roles, “you two contract directly, we just make the match and guarantee payment” is a genuinely differentiated, on-message position — but per the payments skill, this must never be phrased as having bypassed agency classification. Any public-facing copy on this point should go through Martin first.

14

Use the referral loop that's already latent in the product

REQUIRES YOUR OK

Favorites + Instant Booking already encourage a pharmacy to keep re-booking the same trusted locum. The natural extension is letting a happy locum or pharmacy refer another one — in a shortage market, word-of-mouth between pharmacists carries more weight than most paid channels.

15

Open Dispensaire content publicly as an acquisition channel

REQUIRES YOUR OK

Same recommendation as item 8, repeated here because it compounds over time: public, indexable articles on Quebec-specific pharmacist career/finance topics are a slow-build but durable and free acquisition channel, unlike paid ads which stop working the moment spend stops.

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16

Consider a PharmaGap-style tier experiment once volume justifies it

PharmaGap's pay-per-contract vs. flat-monthly choice is a reasonable pattern for high-volume pharmacies (chains, multi-location owners) who would rather pay a predictable monthly amount than per-shift fees. Not urgent — worth revisiting once there's enough contract volume per pharmacy to know whether it would actually change behavior.

REQUIRES YOUR OK

17

Track a small set of health metrics from day one

Suggest watching: repeat-booking rate (same pharmacy–locum pair), % of published contracts filled within 24h, average compatible-count per posting by region, and payment-guarantee dispute rate once built. These are the numbers that will tell you whether share is durable or just first-mover novelty.

REQUIRES YOUR OK

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SUGGESTED SEQUENCING

If everything above is authorized, a reasonable order — biggest trust/revenue risk first, cheap reconciliations in parallel, growth work once the foundation is solid:

Now → launch (next 5–6 weeks)

Stripe Connect payment guarantee (#1) — the one item that should not slip. In parallel: Loi 25/CASL sign-off (#5), Google sign-in + Calendar OAuth (#3/#4), homepage copy reconciliation (#2) if the Stripe build risks running past launch.

At/around launch

Public trust signals (#7), decide on test data + Cloudflare Access (#6).

First 1–3 months post-launch

Density-first regional rollout (#11), the price-comparison pitch once payments are live (#12), open Dispensaire publicly (#8/#15), start tracking health metrics (#17).

Ongoing / as volume grows

Referral loop (#14), “direct relationship” positioning refinement with Martin (#13), pricing-tier experiment once volume supports it (#16).

Nothing above has been built or changed based on this review. Let me know which items to move forward on and I'll pick them up individually.

SOURCES

- Ordre des pharmaciens du Québec (OPQ) — membership and community-pharmacist workforce figures
- AQPP (Association québécoise des pharmaciens propriétaires) — mémoire on remplacement/locum hours and vacancy rate
- Le Devoir — coverage of the Quebec pharmacist shortage and placement-agency dynamics
- Radio-Canada — coverage of Quebec's placement-agency legislation and health-network staffing
- BLG (Borden Ladner Gervais) — legal summary of the Loi limitant le recours aux services d'une agence de placement de personnel
- Québec.ca — official government page on the placement-agency law and its phase-in timeline
- pharmagap.com — product/pricing pages
- recrupharm.com — service model description
- Growjo and public listings referencing BeLocum's scale and model
- C-Direct internal documents: c-direct-payments skill (payment architecture), PRELANCEMENT.md, LAUNCH.md, live site (index.html, faq.html, regles.html, disponibilites.html), and current Supabase/codebase state